

Data Day 2027 — Ways to Participate (DRAFT)

Audience: outward / participant-facing (website + Call for Proposals packet). **Status:** working draft. Placeholders in **[brackets]** need confirmation (dates, links, the program committee's name). Voice follows the Regional Data Agenda — mission-forward and inviting.

Plotting What's Next

Five years forward for Central Ohio's data community

Data Day returns for its **fifth year** on **Thursday, February 18, 2027** — and this milestone is a launch pad, not a look back. Across five years, Data Day has convened Central Ohio's public-sector data community — **local governments, nonprofits, educational institutions, and civic-minded businesses** — around a shared vision: **to make Central Ohio a leader in using data to improve the quality of life for all residents**. *Plotting What's Next* turns that momentum toward what comes next, and we want you in the room helping shape it.

There are many ways to take part — whether you want to present your work, lead a hands-on session, share a research poster, or connect with peers across the region. Explore the formats below and find the one that fits.

Present at Data Day

Lecture sessions

Open call for proposals

The backbone of the program. A lecture is a **45-minute breakout** (with time built in for questions and discussion) in which you share a project, method, dataset, tool, or lesson learned with a room of practitioners. Sessions span all skill levels — from introductory to advanced — and we welcome proposals from across the four constituencies.

- **Format:** 45 minutes, including Q&A.
- **Rooms:** Terrace A, Terrace B, or the Grand Ballroom.

- **Who can propose:** anyone — individuals or teams.
- **What to tell us:** title, objectives, description, topic tags and skill level, and speaker(s). (*Full question list under “What we’ll ask you to submit” below.*)

Hands-on workshops

Open call for proposals

A **90-minute, technically focused working session** where participants follow along and build something — a workshop is for skills, tools, and methods that are best learned by doing. Workshops are held in a classroom-style room with tables and power; attendees are expected to bring a laptop.

- **Format:** 90 minutes, hands-on; participants work along with the facilitator.
- **Room:** Grand Ballroom B (technical setup — tables, power).
- **Who can propose:** anyone comfortable leading an interactive, applied session.
- **What to tell us:** title, learning goals, the tools/skills covered, any prerequisites or setup attendees need, and the skill level.

Panel discussions

Curated by the program committee

A **moderated, multi-speaker conversation** on a regional data topic, assembled by the [program committee] to bring balanced perspectives to the stage. Panels are not part of the open call — but if you have a topic or potential panelists to suggest, we’d love to hear from you.

- **Format:** 45 minutes, moderated, multiple speakers.
- **Room:** Grand Ballroom.
- **How to take part:** [suggest a panel topic or panelist →] (*link / form TBD*).

Choosing a skill level

Every session carries a **technical skill level (0–3)** in the agenda so attendees can find sessions that match their comfort. When you submit, tell us where your session fits:

Level	Who it’s for
0 — All audiences	No technical background needed; conceptual, strategic, or policy-oriented.
1 — Beginner	Some data familiarity helpful; introduces a tool or method.
2 — Intermediate	Assumes working knowledge; hands-on with specific tools/methods.
3 — Advanced	For experienced practitioners; deep or specialized technical content.

We aim for a program that spans all four levels — entry points for newcomers *and* depth for seasoned practitioners are equally welcome.

Spotlight on emerging talent

Intern Showcase — lightning talks

By invitation / selection

A fast-paced, plenary lightning round over lunch that puts **emerging data talent** in front of the full Data Day audience. The Showcase features interns from **MORPC's Summer Internship Program**, who are placed with local governments and institutions across the region and bring fresh perspective to real public-sector data work.

- **Format:** short lightning talks (~5–7 minutes each), presented to the full room during lunch.
 - **Who's eligible:** participants in MORPC's Summer Internship Program.
 - **How it works:** interns submit their projects; a selection committee chooses a few for the lightning talks. **Projects not selected for a talk are invited to present as posters** (see below) — one submission, two ways to shine.
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Share your research — posters

Poster presentations are displayed throughout the venue all day, with dedicated **attended poster times** during breaks and lunch when presenters stand by their work to talk with attendees. Two groups feed the poster gallery:

Intern posters

Accepted **intern projects not selected for lightning talks** are presented as posters — giving every accepted intern a place on the program.

Student poster Call for Proposals

Open call for proposals — Central Ohio students

We invite **college, university, and graduate students** from across the region to submit posters sharing their data-driven research, analysis, or applied projects. The student poster CFP is a chance to share your work with the region's data community, get feedback from practitioners, and make connections early in your career.

- **Who can propose:** currently enrolled college, university, and graduate students at Central Ohio institutions.
 - **Format:** printed poster, displayed all day; you'll staff it during attended poster times.
 - **What to tell us:** title, abstract, your program/institution, and advisor (if any).
 - **Specs:** [poster size/orientation, board vs. easel, setup time — TBD].
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Exhibit & connect

Organizations and vendors are invited to **table in the Gallery** for the full day — a high-traffic space during registration, breaks, and lunch — to connect with the region's data community, showcase tools and services, and support the event. Tabling is part of Data Day's [sponsorship / exhibitor program → link TBD].

Attend the keynotes

Every attendee shares two plenary moments: a **morning keynote** to open the day and a **lunch keynote**. Keynote speakers are invited by the program committee. Have someone inspiring in mind? **Suggest a keynote** →

What we'll ask you to submit (by format)

A quick preview of the questions each submission form will cover. Items marked (*internal*) help MORPC staff understand and balance the program — they aren't printed in the agenda.

Lecture

- Applicant name and contact (primary contact for the proposal)
- Speaker(s) and organizational affiliations
- Session title (≤10 words)
- Up to three session objectives — what the audience will gain or learn
- Session description (≤100 words) — the “why attend this session?” blurb for the brochure
- Session abstract (longer) — content, topics, format, intended audience, expected outcomes
- Topic tags (up to two, from the list of eleven in the CFP)
- Technical skill level (0–3)
- Regional Data Agenda **focus area** (*internal*)

- Regional Data Agenda **action pillar** (*internal*)
- Reflection: “How does your session advance [focus area] as a regional data priority?” (*internal*)
- How you’ll engage the audience / encourage participation
- AV and technology needs

Workshop

Everything in the lecture list, plus the hands-on specifics: - Learning goals — what participants will build or be able to do afterward - Tools and software used - Prerequisites — what attendees should already know - Required setup beforehand (installs, accounts) and whether a laptop is needed - Ideal group size / any participant cap - Special room, power, or AV needs

Panel (*suggestion*)

- Your name and contact (the person suggesting the panel)
- Proposed panel topic / working title
- Why this topic matters to the region now
- Key questions or angles the panel would explore
- Suggested moderator and/or panelists with affiliations (optional)
- (*Topic tags, focus area, action pillar, and skill level are assigned by staff.*)

Intern Showcase — lightning talk or poster

One submission; the committee selects lightning talks, and remaining projects become posters. - Intern name and contact - Internship host organization / placement - Project title - Project summary — the question, the data, what you did, and the result - Why it matters — impact for the host organization or community - Any visuals or slides you’d use (optional)

Student poster

- Student name and contact
 - Institution and program; advisor (if any)
 - Poster title
 - Abstract — research/project summary: question, data and methods, findings or status
 - (*Posters carry no topic, skill, or focus tags; see poster specs for size and format.*)
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Key dates & how to submit

Milestone	Date
Call for Proposals opens (lectures, workshops, student posters)	[TBD]
Proposal deadline	[TBD]
Notifications	[TBD]
Data Day 2027	Thursday, February 18, 2027

Submit / suggest: [CFP link — TBD] · Suggest a keynote · [contact email — TBD]

Questions? Contact the Data Day team at [email].